Northwind HomeGuard - Policy Wording

Edition 2025-01. This wording applies to HomeGuard policies that started or renewed from 1 January 2025 to 31 December 2025. It was replaced by Edition 2026-01. Northwind Mutual Insurance Society is registered in Verdania under number NM-40417 and supervised by the Verdanian Financial Conduct Office.

How this policy works

This policy wording, your schedule and any endorsements form your contract with us. The schedule shows which sections you have chosen, the sums insured and the period of insurance. Please read all three documents together and keep them in a safe place.

Words in bold have the meaning given in the Definitions section wherever they appear.

Section 1 - Definitions

Buildings: the structure of your home, its permanent fixtures and fittings, outbuildings, garages, walls, gates, fences, drives, paths, patios, swimming pools and tennis courts, all within the boundaries of the land belonging to your home.

Contents: household goods and personal belongings that you own or are legally responsible for, inside your home, including valuables and money up to the limits in Section 3.

Valuables: jewellery, watches, items of gold, silver or other precious metals, works of art, collections of stamps, coins or medals, furs, and portable electronic devices.

Unoccupied: not lived in by you or a member of your family for more than 45 days in a row. A home is lived in when someone sleeps there on most nights.

Excess: the amount you pay towards each claim. The excess applies per incident and per section.

Period of insurance: the period shown on your schedule, normally twelve months, and any later period for which you pay and we accept the premium.

Section 2 - Buildings cover

We cover loss of or damage to your buildings caused by: fire, lightning, explosion or smoke; storm or flood; escape of water or oil from any fixed installation; theft or attempted theft; subsidence, heave or landslip; impact by vehicles, aircraft, trees or animals; malicious damage or vandalism; and earthquake.

Alternative accommodation. If your home cannot be lived in after damage we cover, we pay reasonable costs of comparable accommodation for you, your family and your pets, up to 15% of the buildings sum insured and for no longer than 12 months.

Trace and access. We pay up to €5,000 for finding the source of an escape of water and repairing the damage caused in finding it.

Accidental damage to buildings is covered only if your schedule shows the Accidental Damage extension.

Section 3 - Contents cover

We cover loss of or damage to your contents caused by any of the events listed in Section 2.

Limits within the contents sum insured:

Item	Limit
Valuables in total	30% of the contents sum insured
Any single valuable, unless listed on the schedule	€2,000
Money and cash	€400
Garden contents	€1,000
Contents temporarily removed from the home	15% of the contents sum insured
Frozen food spoiled by a power cut	€600
Contents in outbuildings and garages	€3,000

Any single valuable worth more than €2,000 must be listed on your schedule with its value, otherwise the most we pay for it is €2,000.

Section 4 - Excess

Claim type	Excess per incident
Standard (all claims unless shown below)	€250
Escape of water	€400
Subsidence, heave or landslip	€1,500
Claims while the home is unoccupied (where still covered)	€1,000
Home emergency add-on	none

Only one excess applies when a single incident causes damage to both buildings and contents and both are insured with us under this policy; it is the higher of the two.

Section 5 - Exclusions

We do not cover:

1. Theft, attempted theft, escape of water, escape of oil and malicious damage while your home is unoccupied.
2. Wear and tear, gradual deterioration, rot, damp, condensation, insects or vermin.
3. Damage that happened before the period of insurance began.
4. Loss caused by war, terrorism (except as required by Verdanian law), nuclear risks or confiscation by a public authority.
5. Loss of data or damage caused by a computer virus or a cyber attack.
6. Storm damage to gates, hedges and fences.
7. The cost of replacing undamaged items that belong to a set or a suite when only part of it is damaged.

Section 6 - Claims conditions

- Tell us about a claim as soon as you can and in any case within 30 days of the incident.
- Report theft, attempted theft, malicious damage and lost property to the police within 24 hours of discovering it and get a crime reference number.
- Keep damaged items until we have seen them, unless we agree otherwise.
- You may arrange emergency repairs to prevent further damage up to €1,000 without asking us first. Keep the invoices.
- Do not admit liability or offer payment to anyone without our written consent.

Section 7 - Cancellation

Cooling-off period. You can cancel within 14 days of receiving your documents, or of the start date if later, and we refund the premium in full, unless you have made a claim.

After the cooling-off period you can cancel at any time; we refund the premium for the unused period less an administration fee of €35. No refund is due if a claim has been paid in the current period of insurance.

We may cancel the policy by giving you 14 days' written notice to your last known address, for example if you do not pay the premium or if we find evidence of fraud.

Section 8 - Home emergency add-on

If your schedule shows Home Emergency, we pay for a contractor to deal with a sudden emergency at your home, such as a failed boiler, a burst pipe or a lost key. We pay up to €500 per incident for call-out, labour and parts, for up to 4 incidents in each period of insurance. Call the 24-hour emergency line on +00 31 998 1914.

Section 9 - Complaints

If you are unhappy with our service, contact Northwind Customer Relations, PO Box 7720, Halloway Street, Kelmere. We will acknowledge your complaint within 5 business days and give a final response within 8 weeks. If you are still not satisfied you may refer it to the Insurance Ombuds Office of Verdania free of charge.

Section 10 - General conditions

General condition 1. Copies of earlier versions of this document are kept in the archive and can be requested. They apply only to the period stated on their cover.

General condition 2. Headings in this document are for convenience only and do not affect its interpretation. Words in the singular include the plural and the other way round.

General condition 3. Notices must be given in writing. A notice sent through the customer portal counts as written notice from the moment it is shown as delivered.

General condition 4. Customers with accessibility needs can ask for this document in large print, audio or another format at no extra cost.

General condition 5. Headings in this document are for convenience only and do not affect its interpretation. Words in the singular include the plural and the other way round.

General condition 6. Staff are trained to explain these terms in plain language. If anything is unclear, ask for an explanation before you rely on your understanding of it.

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General condition 8. Nothing in this document limits any right that cannot be limited under the law that applies to it. If a provision is found invalid, the rest remains in force.

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General condition 12. References to a law include that law as amended or re-enacted from time to time and any regulation made under it.

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General condition 14. Copies of earlier versions of this document are kept in the archive and can be requested. They apply only to the period stated on their cover.

General condition 15. We process personal data as described in our privacy notice. We keep records only for as long as we need them for the purposes stated there.

General condition 16. We may appoint agents and subcontractors to perform any part of this agreement. We remain responsible for what they do on our behalf.

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General condition 20. We process personal data as described in our privacy notice. We keep records only for as long as we need them for the purposes stated there.

General condition 21. A failure or delay in exercising a right is not a waiver of that right, and a single or partial exercise does not prevent any further exercise of it.

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General condition 25. Notices must be given in writing. A notice sent through the customer portal counts as written notice from the moment it is shown as delivered.

General condition 26. The parties will try to resolve any dispute by discussion between senior representatives before starting formal proceedings.

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General condition 29. Any change to this document must be agreed in writing, except where it says that we may change a part of it by publishing a new version.

General condition 30. We may rely on information you give us. You must tell us promptly when that information changes, because a change may affect the service or the price.

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General condition 41. Where this document refers to a person, that includes a company, a partnership and any other body with legal personality, and their lawful successors.

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General condition 45. Copies of earlier versions of this document are kept in the archive and can be requested. They apply only to the period stated on their cover.

General condition 46. Where an amount is stated including tax, the tax rate in force on the date of the invoice applies, and a change in the rate changes the amount accordingly.

General condition 47. Copies of earlier versions of this document are kept in the archive and can be requested. They apply only to the period stated on their cover.

General condition 48. This document and the documents it refers to are the whole agreement between the parties on its subject and replace any earlier understanding.

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General condition 57. This document and the documents it refers to are the whole agreement between the parties on its subject and replace any earlier understanding.

General condition 58. If there is a conflict between a schedule and the main text, the schedule applies for the matter it covers and the main text applies for everything else.

General condition 59. We may appoint agents and subcontractors to perform any part of this agreement. We remain responsible for what they do on our behalf.

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